

Memories of partition, lessons from the wild

My father was in a transferable job in the state services. I joined the Central Government. It was an **extension** of the life I had led earlier. I could not **appreciate** it then, but my journey was a **bed of roses** compared to many who were **unfortunate** to have been **uprooted** from their homes. I met a gentleman at Corbett during a literature festival I attended a few years ago. He was born in a Punjabi family in Lahore in undivided India. I looked **incredulously** at him as he told me about his age with a **twinkle** in his eyes — not yet 80 but getting there within a few months. He **reminisced** over dinner about a time long past. He crossed over to India with his parents and siblings as a four-plus, something child at the time of Partition. His family travelled to Bombay. He still remembered living in the camp and using **communal** toilets for eight years. **The life** in the **refugee** camp **was** something that the family had never even dreamed of. The circumstances did not **deter** him. He studied and joined the merchant navy. The **decision** to quit a well-paying job and settle in Goa, taken four **decades** back, **was** not a difficult one for the young couple. He **established** a shipbuilding company.

As his two sons **grew up**, he realised that he would want to **pursue** other **passions** as the **fancy** might strike him. He has **handed over** the business to his sons and spends time travelling and writing. His smile was genuine, without a **trace** of **bitterness**, as he narrated his story. His is not an **isolated narrative**. More than seven million people **migrated** to India, and an almost equal number left the country at the time of Independence. They left behind memories and friends, and much of the wealth acquired over generations. They **persevered** to make a new life, with a **resolve** not to **give up**.

During our stay in Corbett, we also went for a jungle safari in search of the tiger. I **struck up a conversation** with the guide on our way back to the resort. It was an eye-opener for me. **Apparently**, a few of the tigers had been **relocated** by the Government to the **adjoining** jungle. If the guide and the driver were to be believed, the animals had not taken kindly to this forced migration. **Many** of the cheetahs relocated to the jungles from Africa also **do** not appear to be doing well in an **alien habitat**. My new friend made a success of his life through hard work, but he cannot forget the camp. Decades have failed to erase the **traumatic** memories. The animals may not have the emotions that we usually **attribute to** humans, but translocation seems to have disturbed them equally hard. The past hundred-odd years **witnessed** major **upheavals** globally. We are witnessing more frequent mass **exodus** and even **reverse migration**. **Empathy** towards fellow humans and our **innate goodness** **is** the casualty. The decisions may have been taken by our **forefathers**. It does not matter. We must move on. The **onus lies** with nations having more than enough resources to **last** them long after we and our **progeny** are gone. They need to show **empathy** towards the others not so **fortunate**. A beginning must be made by accepting the need to **resolve**. Each **complexity** can always be **broken down** for a workable solution. The dreams of a few may **sound utopian** today. We must work to make them a shared objective. **All** of us, **across the divides**, **owe** it to humanity to find solutions and leave a **legacy** for the future.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Extension** (noun) – expansion, prolongation, continuation, enlargement, stretching विस्तार
2. **Appreciate** (verb) – value, recognize, acknowledge, understand, be grateful for कद्र करना
3. **A bed of roses** (phrase) – easy life, comfort, idyll, cakewalk, picnic आरामदेह स्थिति
4. **Unfortunate** (adjective) – unlucky, hapless, ill-fated, lamentable, regrettable बदकिस्मत
5. **Uproot** (verb) – displace, evict, deracinate, expel, dislodge विस्थापित करना
6. **Incredulously** (adverb) – skeptically, doubtfully, disbelievingly, dubiously, questioningly अविश्वास से
7. **Twinkle** (noun) – sparkle, glint, gleam, glitter, shimmer चमक
8. **Reminisce** (verb) – recall, recollect, look back, hark back, muse स्मरण करना
9. **Communal** (adjective) – shared, collective, public, common, community सामुदायिक
10. **Refugee** (noun) – displaced person, asylum seeker, exile, evacuee, migrant शरणार्थी
11. **Deter** (verb) – discourage, dissuade, hinder, prevent, deter रोकना
12. **Decade** (noun) – Period of ten years दशक
13. **Establish** (verb) – set up, found, create, institute, build स्थापित करना
14. **Grow up** (phrasal verb) – mature, come of age, develop, be raised, reach adulthood बड़ा होना
15. **Pursue** (verb) – follow, chase, seek, engage in, go after अनुसरण करना
16. **Passion** (noun) – enthusiasm, zeal, ardour, fervour, obsession जुनून
17. **Fancy** (noun) – whim, notion, liking, taste, inclination शौक
18. **Hand over** (phrasal verb) – transfer, pass on, deliver, relinquish, cede सौंप देना
19. **Trace** (noun) – hint, vestige, tinge, iota, sign चिह्न
20. **Bitterness** (noun) – resentment, rancour, acrimony, spite, sourness कड़वाहट
21. **Isolated** (adjective) – solitary, one-off, standalone, singular, detached अलग-थलग
22. **Narrative** (noun) – story, account, tale, chronicle, recounting कथा
23. **Migrate** (verb) – relocate, move, resettle, emigrate, immigrate पलायन करना
24. **Persevere** (verb) – persist, endure, keep at it, press on, stay the course डटे रहना

25. **Resolve** (noun) – determination, firmness, willpower, grit, resolution संकल्प
26. **Give up** (phrasal verb) – quit, surrender, abandon, relinquish, desist हार मानना
27. **Strike up a conversation** (phrase) – start a chat, initiate talk, open a conversation, begin to talk, break the ice बातचीत शुरू करना
28. **Apparently** (adverb) – seemingly, evidently, reportedly, ostensibly, outwardly प्रतीतः
29. **Relocate** (verb) – move, shift, transfer, resettle, transplant स्थानांतरित करना
30. **Adjoining** (adjective) – adjacent, neighboring, contiguous, next-door, abutting सन्निकट
31. **Alien** (adjective) – foreign, unfamiliar, strange, extraneous, non-native अपरिचित
32. **Habitat** (noun) – natural home, environment, ecosystem, surroundings, biotope आवास-स्थल
33. **Traumatic** (adjective) – distressing, harrowing, painful, shocking, devastating आघातकारी
34. **Attribute** (to) (verb) – ascribe, assign, credit, impute, pin on कारण मानना
35. **Witness** (verb) – observe, see, experience, undergo, behold देखना
36. **Upheaval** (noun) – turmoil, convulsion, cataclysm, ferment, turbulence उथल-पुथल
37. **Exodus** (noun) – mass departure, migration, flight, evacuation, outflow पलायन
38. **Reverse migration** (noun) – the movement of people from a place of employment to their native homes. विपरीत पलायन
39. **Empathy** (noun) – compassion, understanding, fellow-feeling, sympathy, identification सहानुभूति
40. **Fortunate** (adjective) – lucky, blessed, favoured, providential, well-off भाग्यशाली
41. **Resolve** (verb) – settle, decide, solve, determine, work out समाधान करना
42. **Complexity** (noun) – intricacy, complication, difficulty, convolution, nuance जटिलता
43. **Broke down** (phrasal verb) – decompose, unpack, simplify, disaggregate, parse विभाजित करना
44. **Sound** (verb) – seem, appear, come across as, strike one as, ring as प्रतीत होना
45. **Utopian** (adjective) – idealistic, impractical, visionary, quixotic, dreamy आदर्शवादी
46. **Across the divides** (phrase) – overcoming or bridging significant differences or barriers between people or groups.

47. **Owe** (verb) – be indebted to, be obliged to,
be beholden to, be due to, owe to ऋणी
होना

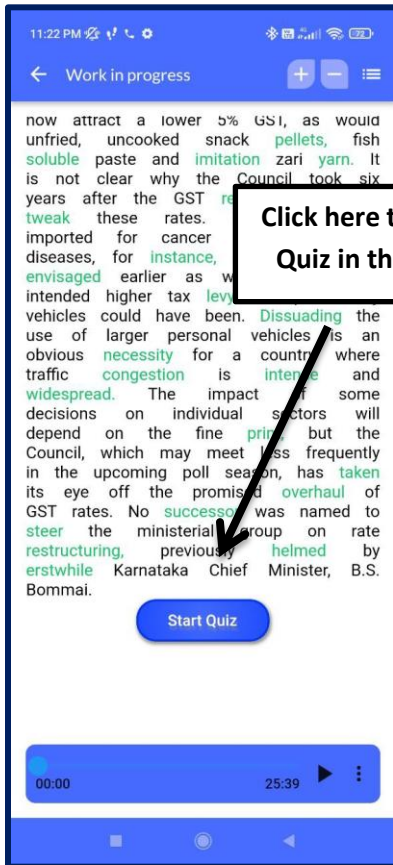
48. **Legacy** (noun) – heritage, bequest,
inheritance, patrimony, lasting gift धरोहर

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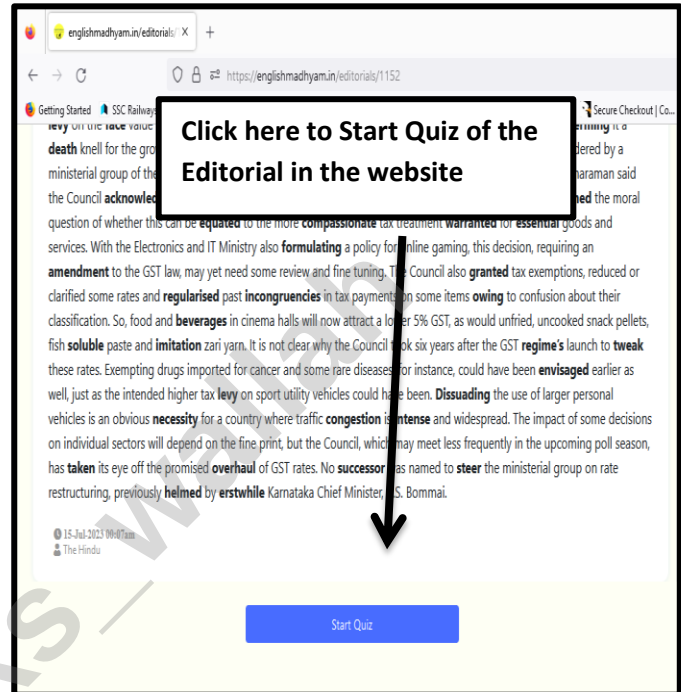
Summary of the Editorial

1. The author recalls meeting a gentleman at a literature festival in Corbett who was born in Lahore before Partition.
2. The man migrated to India as a small child with his family during Partition.
3. His family lived in a refugee camp in Bombay for eight years, enduring harsh conditions and communal facilities.
4. Despite hardships, he pursued education and later joined the merchant navy.
5. He eventually quit a well-paying job to settle in Goa and started a shipbuilding company.
6. His two sons now manage the business, while he follows his passions like travelling and writing.
7. He narrates his life with positivity, showing no bitterness despite traumatic experiences.
8. His story represents the resilience of millions who were uprooted during Partition.
9. Over seven million people migrated to India and a similar number left for Pakistan, leaving behind homes, wealth, and friendships.
10. The refugees rebuilt their lives with determination and perseverance.
11. During a jungle safari in Corbett, the author learns that relocated tigers struggle to adjust in new habitats.
12. Similarly, African cheetahs relocated to Indian jungles also face difficulties in adapting.
13. This parallel highlights how both humans and animals suffer deeply from forced displacement.
14. The past century has seen large-scale migrations worldwide, often leading to loss of empathy and compassion.
15. The author concludes that wealthy nations must take responsibility, show empathy, and work towards shared solutions for displacement, leaving behind a humane legacy for future generations.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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